▼ GLASSHOUSE



STRATEGIC PASS

At 76, Andhra Pradesh chief minister **N. Chandrababu Naidu** has discovered a new electorate, Gen Alpha, and its viral '6-7' challenge. Teenagers visiting his office had him answering rapid-fire questions while waving his arms up and down, mimicking the trend's signature gesture. Hyderabad or Amaravati? "Both," he said, before conceding that "at present, it's Amaravati". The affection for the city he helped turn into an IT hub showed again when he chose Hyderabadi biryani over Nellore's fish stew. His Telugu Desam Party (TDP) beat Heritage, the family's dairy business. Yoga trumped the gym, and work edged out family time. But the veteran politician drew the line at Balakrishna versus Pawan Kalyan. One is his brother-in-law and father-in-law to his son, Nara Lokesh. The other is his deputy CM and indispensable ally. Naidu laughed off the question with a firm "No". Guess some choices are hard, particularly when family loyalties collide with coalition arithmetic.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ GAMCHHA WARS IN UP

SACRED WEAPON

For **Swami Adgadanand** of Mirzapur's Sakteshgarh ashram, political visitors are nothing new. Samajwadi Party chief **Akhilesh Yadav**, ex-Madhya Pradesh CM Shivraj Singh Chouhan, RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat, they have all sought his blessings. On October 31, it was **Yogi Adityanath's** turn, though this one was long-distance. The seer's disciple, Narad Maharaj, met the Uttar Pradesh CM in Lucknow, presented



him with a copy of Yatharth Geeta and a pink *gamchha* as prasad, and invited him to the ashram. Yogi spoke to the seer over video call and, reportedly, got blessings for a long life. But the gamchha was the real story. Akhilesh's pink one, reportedly sent by the same guru, became a fixture of his 2024 Lok Sabha campaign, when the SP won 37 seats in Uttar Pradesh. Now, with the 2027 assembly polls approaching, Yogi, too, has the guru's blessings. We'll have to wait and see whose shade of pink will prevail in the ultimate battle.